



OUTLIERS

What You Store

Layer 3 of 8 · Recording what happened,
and letting everything else be worked out.

FOR MAC

EST. MMXXVI · OUTLIERS ACCELERATOR

Facts, not descriptions

A description of a relationship starts going out of date the moment you write it. A record of something that happened stays correct, because it happened.

WHAT THE LAST LAYER LEFT YOU WITH

Your records have a shape and your system can tell one person from another. But the fields you would naturally fill in, such as their job title or how warm the relationship is, are claims about a moving world. Nobody has to touch them for them to become wrong.

WHAT THIS LAYER BUILDS

This layer changes what you keep. Instead of writing down what is true about someone today, your system records what *happened*, one line at a time. Everything else, including when you last spoke and where the relationship stands, is worked out from those lines whenever you ask.

WRITTEN BY HAND

last spoke: recently

relationship: warm

job title: Head of Ops

true on the day you typed it

RECORDED AS IT HAPPENED



NOBODY TYPES THE RIGHT-HAND BOX. IT IS CALCULATED.

How it works

The rules below all follow from the first one, which is that nothing already written down is ever changed.

1. ONLY ADD. NEVER EDIT

What happened goes into a list, one line each, and nothing already in that list is ever changed or removed. If you got something wrong, you add a correction; you do not go back and alter history. That means the record of your relationships cannot change under you without a line being added, so what it said last month is still there.

2. A SHORT, FIXED LIST OF WHAT COUNTS AS SOMETHING HAPPENING

You wrote to them. They replied. A call was booked. You met. They changed jobs. They went quiet. Your system knows that list and refuses anything not on it, which stops this becoming another mess in 6 months. The installer asks what counts as contact in your line of work, because a site visit or a quote sent matters in some businesses and not others.

3. THE DESCRIPTIVE FIELDS ARE NOW CALCULATED, AND YOU STOP TYPING THEM

When you last spoke is the date of the most recent event. How many exchanges you have had is a count. Where the relationship stands follows rules you can read: a reply makes someone active, and a conversation that has gone quiet past a length of time you choose parks itself.

Nobody has to decide to give up on a thread. It steps aside on its own, so your list of live conversations reflects what is still moving.

WHAT HAPPENS IF THERE IS NO HISTORY YET

Then your system says so, rather than guessing. Someone with nothing recorded against them has not gone cold. Nothing has been observed about them yet. A CRM that assigns a status on no evidence produces a status you cannot rely on.

Before you start on a Mac

Everything in this guide is typed into **Terminal**, the Mac's window for typing commands instead of clicking. Press Command and Space together, type Terminal, and press Return.

This layer needs Python and git, which you set up for Layer 1 (its page "Before you start on a Mac"), and the layers before this one. It installs no add-ons, so it works with either Python a Mac may have.

HOW TO TYPE THE LINES

Where this guide shows several lines in a black box, type them one at a time: type the first, press Return, wait for it to finish and give you a fresh line, then type the next. The installer asks you questions. Each offers an answer in [square brackets]; press Return to take it, or type your own and press Return.

WHERE YOUR CRM IS

Layer 1 made your CRM at ~/CRM: a folder called CRM in your home folder (the folder with your name and the house picture in Finder's sidebar). If you chose another folder in Layer 1, put your own folder wherever a line in this guide says ~/CRM. The installer finds your CRM by itself either way.

Apple Silicon or Intel (the 2 kinds of chip a Mac can have; the Apple menu, then About This Mac, shows yours): the steps are the same on both, and both were tested.

Tried only on test Macs. Every step in this guide and in the instructions file of the layer's download was tried on test Macs (Macs GitHub rents out by the minute to run a script, not a person's own Mac, and not yours), never on a real Mac, except 1: the box asking to install the developer tools, which cannot appear on a test Mac. The last pages list every line and what happened to it.

Build it

3 lines, typed into Terminal. The last one asks you a few questions so what you get is yours, then does the work.

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-crm-03-records-mac
cd outliers-crm-03-records-mac
python3 install.py
```

This layer needs Layers 1 and 2. It will check, and tell you if something is missing.

WHAT IT ASKS YOU, AND WHY

QUESTION	WHAT IT CHANGES
What counts as contact in your business?	A message, a call, a site visit, a quote sent, a session delivered. Your list, because a builder and a coach do not count the same events.
After how long is a quiet conversation over?	30 days suits most people. Whatever you choose, conversations older than that step aside on their own instead of sitting on your list making you feel guilty.

WHAT YOU END UP WITH

- A single history file that only ever gets added to.
- A tool that works out, from that history, when you last spoke to anyone and where each relationship stands.
- A rule that quiet conversations park themselves, so nothing sits on your list forever.
- The rules for what counts as live and what has gone quiet, in plain English, in a file you can edit.

Now use it

This one only pays off once Layer 4 is filling the history for you. Read what it will do, and come back to it.

If you brought in a contacts export at Layer 1, you can try the calculation now on the handful of people you have spoken to since. Otherwise there is nothing useful to do here yet, and this guide is not going to invent an exercise to fill the space.

What is worth doing is reading the rules the installer wrote for deciding what counts as live and what has gone quiet. Open your CRM folder in Obsidian and look for a folder called **_layers**, usually at the bottom of the list. The rules are 3 short paragraphs in plain English, and your system uses them for as long as you run it. If you disagree with any, change them now, while it costs nothing.

IF YOU ALREADY HAD SOMETHING LIKE THIS

Your test: ask your existing system who you have not spoken to in 60 days. If the answer comes from a field somebody typed, it is a guess. If you cannot get an answer at all, this layer is the one you are missing.

WHAT THIS LAYER LEAVES UNSOLVED

A history is only as good as what reaches it, and right now the only one who could put anything in it is you, typing. That is the admin that kills CRMs, so putting it back in at this point would undo the whole point of the exercise.

NEXT: LAYER 4 • CAPTURE

Your system starts filling its own history from the places your conversations already happen. This is where the typing stops and your CRM starts giving back.

WORDS USED IN THIS GUIDE

Event	A record that something happened, with a date and where it came from.
Append-only	A file that only ever has lines added. Nothing already written is changed.
Calculated field	Something worked out from your history rather than typed in.
Parked	A conversation that has gone quiet and stepped aside on its own.

What was run on a Mac

A **test Mac** is one of the Macs GitHub rents out by the minute to run a script.

Each line below is one this guide or the instructions file of the layer's download (README.md) gives you to type.

The run was on 2026-09-26. A script (a list of commands each test Mac carries out by itself) downloaded a fresh copy of the download from GitHub on each of 7 test Macs and ran each line below exactly as printed, in this order. After a `cd` line (`cd` moves Terminal into a folder), the lines that follow ran in that folder, as they do for you. The script ran them; no person typed them.

7 test runs: 3 on Macs set up from scratch (macOS 15.7.9 on Apple Silicon, macOS 15.7.9 on Intel, macOS 26.6.2 on Apple Silicon), and 4 on 2 Macs that also have Homebrew, an add-on installer many Mac owners use, each run once with Homebrew installed before Python and once after (macOS 15.7.9 on Apple Silicon and macOS 15.7.9 on Intel). Before the first line, the script put these on every Mac: Python from python.org; Layers 1 and 2 of the CRM, installed from their Mac downloads. GitHub's Macs already have Apple's developer tools, which include git.

EACH LINE, THEN WHAT HAPPENED TO IT

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-crm-03-records-mac
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
cd outliers-crm-03-records-mac
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 install.py
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
cd ~/CRM
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 _engine/ledger.py types
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 _engine/ledger.py stats
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 _engine/ledger.py tail 20
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 _engine/derive.py show "a name or link"
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 _engine/derive.py quiet 60
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

EACH LINE, CONTINUED

```
python3 _engine/derive.py summary
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
cd ~/outliers-crm-03-records-mac
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

```
python3 tests/test_ledger_and_derive.py
```

worked on all 7 test Macs

The script's record of the run is public, for anyone who wants to check it; you do not need to open it:

<https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-mac-test/actions/runs/36210553201>

NOT RUN ON THE TEST MACS

The box asking to install the developer tools cannot appear on a test Mac, because GitHub's Macs already have them.

Opening your CRM in Obsidian. The test Macs have no Obsidian; the script read the folders and files the installer made instead.